

OpenClaw Model Switching

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1. Course Content

This course will systematically introduce OpenClaw's model selection mechanism and three methods for switching models.

2. Temporary Session Model Switching

2.1 Open TUI Session

- Terminal input

```
openclaw tui
```

2.2 Use /model to Switch Session Model

Command	Description
<code>/model</code>	View available model list, select and switch model

- Type `/model` in the session box and press Enter. For example, here we select to switch to `bailian/qwen3.5-plus`. Use keyboard up/down keys to select model, then press Enter

```
agent main | session main (openclaw-tusearch: >
→ bailian/glm-4.7
  bailian/MiniMax-M2.5
  bailian/qwen3.5-plus
```

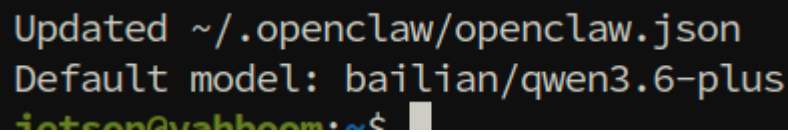
3. Switch Default Model

3.1 Switch via CLI

The simplest way is to use CLI command to directly set the default model:

- Here we use switching to `bailian/qwen3.6-plus` model as an example

```
openclaw models set bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```



```
Updated ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Default model: bailian/qwen3.6-plus
```

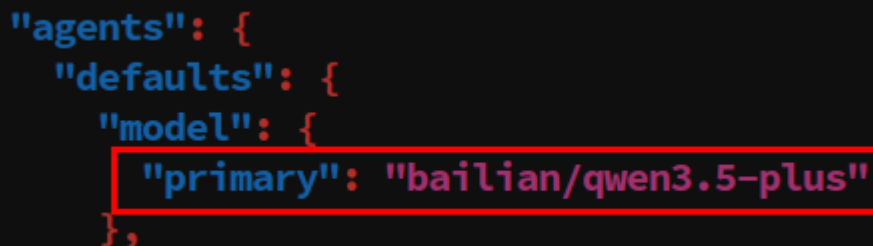
3.2 Switch via Configuration File

- Edit `openclaw.json` configuration file to modify Agent's default model

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your preferred editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

In `openclaw.json`, specify the default primary model through the `agents.defaults.model.primary` configuration item:

```
{
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
      }
    }
  }
}
```



```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "tools": {
```

- Verify if configuration takes effect:

```
openclaw models status
```

```
Before running loads
Config      : ~/.openclaw/openclaw.json
Agent dir   : ~/.openclaw/agents/main/agent
Default     : bailian/qwen3.5-plus
Fallbacks (0) : -
Image model  : -
Image fallbacks (0): -
Aliases (0)  : -
Configured models (9): bailian/qwen3.5-plus, bailian/qwen3.6-plus, bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23, bailian/qwen3-coder-next, bailian/qwen3-coder-plus, bailian/MiniMax-M2.5, bailian/glm-5, bailian/glm-4.7, bailian/kimi-k2.5
```

4. Add Model Options List

- `agents.defaults.models` is OpenClaw's **allowed list/catalog** that controls the range of usable models. When this configuration item is set, users can only use models contained in the list. This list serves as the model range control basis for both the `/model` command and session overrides.

4.1 Add Models via Configuration File

Configure `agents.defaults.models` in `openclaw.json` and add required models to the allowed list:

```
"agents": {
  "defaults": {
    "model": {
      "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
    },
    "models": {
      "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
      "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
      "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
    },
    "workspace": "/home/jetson/.openclaw/workspace",
    "compaction": {
      "mode": "safeguard",
      "memoryFlush": {
        "enabled": false
      }
    }
  }
}
```

```
2  "agents": {
3    "defaults": {
4      "model": {
5        "primary": "bailian/qwen3.5-plus"
6      },
7      "models": {
8        "bailian/qwen3.5-plus": {},
9        "bailian/MiniMax-M2.5": {},
10       "bailian/glm-4.7": {}
11      },
12      "workspace": "/home/pi/.openclaw/workspace",
13      "compaction": {
14        "mode": "safeguard",
15        "memoryFlush": {
16          "enabled": false
17        }
18      }
19    }
20  },
```

4.2 Model Reference Format Specification

In OpenClaw, all model references use a unified format:

provider/model-id

Examples:

Model Reference	Description
anthropic/claude-opus-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Opus model
anthropic/claude-sonnet-4-6	Anthropic's Claude Sonnet model
openai/gpt-5.4	OpenAI's GPT-5.4 model
openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2	Model ID itself contains slash

Note: If the model ID itself contains `/` (e.g., `moonshotai/kimi-k2`), you must provide the complete reference in the format `openrouter/moonshotai/kimi-k2`.

5. Appendix: CLI Command Quick Reference

Command	Purpose
openclaw onboard	New user guidance, helps quickly complete initial configuration
openclaw models list	View all configured model list
openclaw models status	View current model configuration status details
/model	View available model list in chat
/model status	View current model status details in chat

